CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 16

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ Her husband needs new reading glasses.
- ◯ Her husband thinks she needs glasses.
- ◯ She has a prescription for new glasses.
- ◯ She wants a second pair of glasses.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ to see if her prescription has changed
- ◯ to figure out if she needs glasses
- ◯ to find out why her left eye hurts
- ◯ to get her yearly check-up

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ She normally gets regular check-ups.
- ◯ She needed a strong prescription.
- ◯ Her problem was an easy one to fix.
- ◯ Her glasses were in such bad shape.

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ colour
- ◯ cost
- ◯ size
- ◯ style

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ They are perfect.
- ◯ They are long lasting.
- ◯ They are too big.
- ◯ They are too colourful.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯
- ◯
- ◯
- ◯

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ He wants her to purchase his expensive cleaner.
- ◯ He wants her glasses to remain in good shape.
- ◯ He thinks people don't clean their glasses enough.
- ◯ He thinks she won't wear her glasses if they are dirty.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ buy another pair of glasses
- ◯ show her husband the bill
- ◯ go to another eyeglass store
- ◯ use the cleaning solution

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to choose award winners
- ◯ to plan the award ceremony
- ◯ to review award applications
- ◯ to change the award process

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ It provides entertainment.
- ◯ It has no purpose.
- ◯ It should be given to everyone.
- ◯ It is an important achievement.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ by choosing the most deserving
- ◯ by reviewing all applications
- ◯ by counting staff votes
- ◯ by drawing names from a box

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ at the summer picnic
- ◯ at the Christmas party
- ◯ at a staff meeting
- ◯ at an awards ceremony

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She is a manager.
- ◯ She is an award candidate.
- ◯ She is a new employee.
- ◯ She will organize the picnic.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He met her at a wedding party last year.
- ◯ He saw her pictures at a wedding fair.
- ◯ His friend was a former client.
- ◯ He found her on a photography website.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ a luxurious garden ceremony
- ◯ a family ceremony in his backyard
- ◯ an outdoor ceremony in a park
- ◯ a simple ceremony at his parents' place

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because the wedding is in a different city
- ◯ because she is already booked for that day
- ◯ because of the man's modest budget
- ◯ because she prefers indoor ceremonies

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because no other photographer is available
- ◯ because Cindy Shin offers a discounted rate
- ◯ because other photographers are less affordable
- ◯ because he appreciates Cindy Shin's work

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ the basic package price without guest portraits
- ◯ the basic package price and extra for portrait photos
- ◯ the basic package price and nothing else
- ◯ the basic package price plus printing of the photographs

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ as a combination of digital and print copies
- ◯ as a specially printed photo album
- ◯ as a collection of 200 prints
- ◯ as an online display of the best photos

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The protesters were _____
- ◯ collecting signatures.
- ◯ disturbing spectators.
- ◯ waiting at city hall.
- ◯ watching racehorses.

2. The protesters believed the sign _____
- ◯ was a safety concern.
- ◯ displayed scary images.
- ◯ had inaccurate content.
- ◯ was too large for the road.

3. Spokesperson Jillian Smith mentioned a cellphone to _____
- ◯ quote a legal case.
- ◯ make a comparison.
- ◯ request information.
- ◯ suggest a solution.

4. The racetrack owner is _____
- ◯ unconvinced.
- ◯ misinformed.
- ◯ confused.
- ◯ uninterested.

5. The police were consulted about _____
- ◯ the protesters' rights.
- ◯ the sign's effectiveness.
- ◯ problems caused by signs.
- ◯ accident rates in the area.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What has the man recently received?
- ◯ complaints
- ◯ evaluations
- ◯ permission
- ◯ requests

2. What describes the emails that the man received?
- ◯ They were poorly written.
- ◯ They are quite misleading.
- ◯ They were from instructors.
- ◯ They were sent by mistake.

3. What is the supervisor's main concern?
- ◯ The essay grades seem too high.
- ◯ The instructors are asking questions.
- ◯ The students are not learning enough.
- ◯ The tutors are not doing their jobs.

4. According to the women, what is cheating?
- ◯ coming for tutoring late in the year
- ◯ failing to tell teachers they got help
- ◯ having routine homework edited
- ◯ receiving help with final essays

5. How would the women probably describe cheaters?
- ◯ They are disadvantaged.
- ◯ They are opportunists.
- ◯ They are too privileged.
- ◯ They are like robbers.

6. How does the woman in the middle respond to the man's last suggestion?
- ◯ She is confused.
- ◯ She is doubtful.
- ◯ She is insincere.
- ◯ She is resistant.

PART 5

7. What will the speakers do to resolve the problem?

- ◯ have the women grade the essays
- ◯ hire more writing skills tutors
- ◯ provide less help with assignments
- ◯ require permission from instructors

8. What does this workplace seem to value?

- ◯ collaborating on making policy decisions
- ◯ designing staff development systems
- ◯ minimizing hiring and payroll costs
- ◯ sustaining consistent client service

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. Benefits of connecting to work online include _____

- ◯ limiting the number of downtown residences.
- ◯ shortening the time spent in meetings.
- ◯ boosting expenditure on recreation.
- ◯ reducing the costs of childcare.

2. Corporate productivity _____

- ◯ may not be influenced by online commuting.
- ◯ will be harmed by employees' lack of social skills.
- ◯ may be improved by staff working from home.
- ◯ is not associated with employees' commute times.

3. Corporations believe that attending a collective workplace

- ◯ is also important for part-time employees.
- ◯ has no bearing on corporate profitability.
- ◯ helps to maintain higher productivity.
- ◯ increases the workload of the managerial staff.

4. Some managers worry that _____

- ◯ employees would bill for incomplete work.
- ◯ their own commute would remain unchanged.
- ◯ they could not manage complex tasks online.
- ◯ they would struggle to supervise their staff.

5. One advantage of the corporate workplace is that it _____

- ◯ helps young people make connections.
- ◯ does not involve online social media distractions.
- ◯ engenders a shared culture and work ethos.
- ◯ provides important opportunities for promotion

6. Proponents of online workspaces claim that _____

- ◯ younger people cannot focus when working in offices.
- ◯ social networking is not prevalent at work.
- ◯ the young generation is moving away from city centers. offices
- ◯ are likely to become obsolete in the future.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	Her husband thinks she needs glasses.
Question 2	to figure out if she needs glasses
Question 3	She needed a strong prescription.
Question 4	cost
Question 5	They are perfect.
Question 6	
Question 7	He wants her glasses to remain in good shape.
Question 8	show her husband the bill

PART 2	
Question 1	to choose award winners
Question 2	It provides entertainment.
Question 3	by drawing names from a box
Question 4	at the summer picnic
Question 5	She is a new employee.

PART 3	
Question 1	His friend was a former client.
Question 2	a simple ceremony at his parents' place
Question 3	because she is already booked for that day
Question 4	because he appreciates Cindy Shin's work
Question 5	the basic package price and nothing else
Question 6	as an online display of the best photos

PART 4	
Question 1	collecting signatures.
Question 2	was a safety concern.
Question 3	make a comparison.
Question 4	unconvinced.
Question 5	problems caused by signs.

PART 5	
Question 1	complaints
Question 2	They are quite misleading.
Question 3	The tutors are not doing their jobs.
Question 4	receiving help with final essays
Question 5	They are opportunists.
Question 6	She is doubtful.
Question 7	require permission from instructors
Question 8	sustaining consistent client service

PART 6	
Question 1	boosting expenditure on recreation.
Question 2	may be improved by staff working from home.
Question 3	helps to maintain higher productivity.
Question 4	they would struggle to supervise their staff.
Question 5	engenders a shared culture and work ethos.
Question 6	offices are likely to become obsolete in the future.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation that takes place in an eyeglass store. The woman has questions about buying glasses. The man, a salesperson, tries to help her.

Section 1:

MAN: Good morning. Can I help you?

WOMAN: Hi. My husband is convinced I need a pair of glasses for reading. I've never had glasses, so I'm not sure what to do.

MAN: Well, you've come to the right place. Have you had your eyes checked recently?

WOMAN: No, not recently. I get regular check-ups from my doctor, but I don't remember him checking my eyes.

MAN: OK, so the first step is to see an eye doctor and get your eyes tested. If your vision needs correcting, the doctor will give you a prescription.

WOMAN: Do you do this testing here?

MAN: Actually, there's an eye clinic right next door. It's on the left. You can go there and make an appointment. If they give you a prescription, bring it here and we can help you.

WOMAN: Thanks. I'll do that right now.

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. Why is the woman visiting the store?
2. does the man suggest going to an eye doctor?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Hi. I was here last week. I did as you suggested and got my eyes tested. I have my prescription.

MAN: Oh yes. Can I see your prescription? . . . Well, Mrs. Mackie, this shows you certainly do need glasses!

WOMAN: Yes, so the doctor said. He was surprised I'd managed to wait so long.

MAN: OK, so first you need to decide which frames you like.

WOMAN: I don't want anything too pricey. Just regular inexpensive glasses to help me see better will be fine.

MAN: Here's what we have in the lower price range. These are plastic frames, and they usually last a long time. I think these would look nice on you. Why don't you try these on and see what you think?

WOMAN: Oh my, they make me look like a different person! The blue frame looks great with my blue eyes. What do you think?

MAN: I agree, and they are a good price. I'll take some measurements so we can prepare the glasses for you. It'll take a couple of weeks for them to be ready.

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. Why was the doctor surprised she had waited so long?
4. What is most important for the woman in choosing glasses?
5. What does the woman think of the frames he suggests?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: I'm here to pick up my new glasses.

MAN: Mrs. Mackie, please have a seat and I'll get them for you . . . Here we are. Try them on.

WOMAN: Oh my goodness, these are awesome! I can see! And the text on my cellphone is so much clearer! I won't text the wrong person now! This is wonderful.

MAN: Here's a special cloth and cleaning solution. If you always use this, the lenses won't get scratched. Just wet the glasses, spray on some solution, then dry them with the cloth. I'd do that every morning.

WOMAN: This is wonderful! My husband will be delighted that I can see now, and that this whole experience didn't cost as much as he feared. Thanks so much!

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. What did the woman come back to the store for?
7. Why does the man talk about cleaning her glasses?
8. What will the woman probably do next?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman. They are trying to make some choices for a work event.

WOMAN: Andrew, do you have a minute? We need to discuss who should get the Top Employee Award.

MAN: Sure, Irene. I guess you and I are this year's selection committee.

WOMAN: I don't know anything about this award. What is it for?

MAN: Well, the selection guidelines are very broad, and there's really no definition for "top." It used to be called Office Choice Award, but that was a popularity contest. Some people even paid friends to vote for them, if you can believe it.

WOMAN: Wow, the award is that important? There are around 70 employees here, but only one person can get the award, right? Unless they make 70 mini-awards, or just give up on the award entirely.

MAN: These ideas were discussed, too. But the award is given during the summer office picnic, and it's part of the fun. The Top Employee Award has been given for three years now. We can only choose 5 recipients, you know.

WOMAN: Really? This is getting interesting. So who got it last year?

MAN: I think Ginette got it because she decorated her office space so well, and because she made the best cheesecake for the picnic. George also won it because of the spectacular entertainment he lined up for our Open House last Christmas.

WOMAN: Oh, so the criteria are that relaxed? It sounds like we could just draw names out of a hat and then justify our choices afterwards!

MAN: Well, to tell you the truth, that is how Ginette and George and the others were chosen last year! We put everyone's names into a box and drew 5. Then we came up with reasons for why they are top employees. Oh, and we don't choose the same people each year, and you and I are not eligible. It's very democratic.

WOMAN: I'll say! And everyone's OK with this system?

MAN: Oh yeah. The award is a highlight of the picnic. Let's get started. This won't take long.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Why are the woman and the man meeting together?
2. What is the man's opinion of the award?
3. How are the award winners chosen?
4. When is the award given?
5. Which statement is probably true about the woman?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation where a man is trying to arrange his upcoming wedding.

MAN: Hello! I'm getting married this July and I'm looking for a wedding photographer. My friend John referred you to me. He got married last September and said you were excellent. I saw your photos and they were beautiful. He also showed me your online portfolio, and I have to say I was really impressed with your sense of design.

WOMAN: Oh thanks, that's nice to hear. Yes, I remember John's wedding. I love garden ceremonies. Well, I'd be very interested in photographing your wedding. Could you first tell me the date and location, so I can check my calendar and see if I'm available?

MAN: Sure! It's July 2nd, and it will be at my parents' property in Halifax. It won't be as fancy as John's wedding, but they have a beautiful backyard overlooking the ocean. My fiancée Sarah and I wanted something outdoors.

WOMAN: Hmmmmm . . . it looks like I am unavailable on that day. I'm flying away to shoot another wedding. Now, when you checked my online portfolio, you must have seen my colleague, Cindy Shin's work. Would you be interested in having her shoot your wedding?

MAN: Oh, that's such a pity. I guess I should have called earlier. Yes, I've seen her work, and I liked it as well. Her work bears a lot of similarities to yours.

WOMAN: It certainly does, and that's because she was my mentor. I'm looking at her schedule and she happens to be available that day.

MAN: That is really lucky! Would prices be comparable?

WOMAN: We charge the same rates, and we offer three different packages. The basic package starts at $3000. It includes an engagement portrait session and complete wedding day coverage, which covers everything from getting ready, to cutting of the cake, dancing, and guest portraits. In addition, we charge travel costs, food, and lodging when the ceremony is out of town.

MAN: Basic is fine with me. That's already slightly over my budget, so I'd rather not be tempted by the other packages! Do I choose which photos I want printed? Is printing included?

WOMAN: Of course. You'll receive a link to an online photo gallery of the best 200 photos within 3 weeks. You can pick out the 50 you like.

MAN: That sounds great. I'll talk it over with my fiancée and get back to you in a few days. Thank you very much!

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. How did the man find out about the photographer?
2. What will the man's wedding be like?
3. Why does the woman suggest another photographer?
4. Why does the man consider the woman's partner?
5. What is the man prepared to pay for?
6. How will the photographer present the photos?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about protesters complaining about a sign.

A group of protesters gathered at the local racetrack yesterday, asking people to sign a petition they intended to take to city hall. The petition requested that a newly erected billboard advertising the racetrack be removed. Protesters claim that the sign, with its blinking lights and animation of a racing horse, is highly distracting. Jillian Smith, spokesperson for the group, pointed out that the human eye is naturally attracted to bright lights and movement. She said that, when you're driving on the highway, that's a very bad thing.

Smith went on to say that using a cellphone while driving is now illegal because of the distraction factor. Therefore, she said, roadside billboard advertising should also be illegal, especially when it is designed to take our attention off the road.

The owner of the racetrack initially refused to comment, but, when pressed, he insisted there was nothing wrong with his sign. He pointed out that there's no law against it, so he sees no obligation to take it down.

Police could neither confirm nor disconfirm that roadside billboards are a contributing factor in highway accidents.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion between three people who work at a college. The two women work as writing skills tutors, and the man is their supervisor.

Max: OK, I've been getting emails that you two are refusing to help students with their writing assignments. It's my understanding—and I thought that you two understood this as well—that that is exactly what your job is. You are the Writing Skills Tutors.

Robin: Yes, but it's the end of the year, and students are coming to us for help with the end-of-the-year assignments worth half their grade! We both think it's cheating and—

Max: Cheating? How so?

Claire: Well, by the time we're through with their essay, we've turned a D essay into a B essay. We've done that. With our comments, our suggestions, our corrections, our questions . . .

Robin: Getting that level of help with a major year-end essay? It isn't fair to the students that have done the work on their own.

Max: Isn't there some way you can, I don't know, lead the students to make the improvements themselves? Show them what to do without doing it for them?

Robin: Normally, yes. But it's March, and the students that are coming to our door now—for the first time—they're not interested in doing the work themselves. They come in, throw their rough notes on the desk, and expect us to do the rest of the work.

Claire: We make suggestions and demonstrate how to use them, but the students just pretend to listen—they didn't come here to learn; they came here for free editing.

Max: So how do you help? I mean, what did we hire you for?

Robin: Well, the way I see it is that we're here to help the students with their homework—the day-to-day assignments. And those students that have gotten help with the practice work are then prepared to do the graded assignments on their own. The others—I assume they don't even do their homework. Like Claire said, they're just here to get their corrections done for free.

Max: What if you helped them with the final assignments only with the teacher's authorization? That way the instructor would know which essays have had the benefit of your help and which ones the students have done on their own. And they can take that into account when they're doing the grading.

Claire: I don't know . . . I guess we could try. As long as the teachers know that what they're grading is partly our work, I guess that would be fair. But—I'm telling you—as soon as word gets out that we're willing to help with final essays, you're going to have to hire another half dozen Writing Skills Tutors.

Robin: At least.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about working from home.

Harold is a sales executive at an export company. Every day he spends two hours on the road getting to and from work. At work, Harold spends his day talking and texting with his clients in China and India. Every week Harold uses a hundred dollars of gas and spends 10 hours stuck in traffic in order to talk to people who are in another country. Surely he could do his work from home.

The question is: Why are we still commuting? Why not allow people like Harold to commute online rather than through our often-clogged transportation systems? If we did allow people to work from home, other economic benefits would follow. We would spend less on gas and more on leisure, education, and other consumer goods. Community restaurants and coffee shops would thrive. More importantly, there would be benefits to the environment with a decrease in gas consumption, especially in urban centres.

Perhaps we are still commuting because corporations still associate productivity with physical presence and hours spent in the office. Clearly, though, corporations could also benefit from employees working at home. With staff working from home, corporate offices could be smaller and hence cheaper to run. Productivity per employee might also increase. Employees would be more able to work at times that might otherwise have been spent commuting. They could also tailor their work schedule to fit their family lives, which would improve their mental health and wellbeing.

It seems that online commuting would have a positive impact on families, corporations, and our society as a whole. We might well wonder, then, why we still encounter traffic gridlock in almost every major city.

Experts say there are four key difficulties with working from home. First, corporations fear offsite employees will be more easily distracted and work less. Second, many managers are concerned that they will not be able to manage staff when their staff are not present in the corporate workplace. A third issue is that the office is not simply a physical location. It is also a psychological space in which a team can develop a sharp, shared focus on the tasks at hand. People who work in the same space can think together and share ideas. Finally, the collective workspace helps staff to feel they belong to a community or culture. They will care more about their company's product or service.

So, will we always work in offices? Younger people increasingly ask to work from home. The younger generation has been raised in a socially networked world in which connections, culture, and creativity are no longer anchored in a geographical or physical space. Perhaps, as some in this generation are already saying, the office will become outdated.